As The Years Go By.....

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/34087057.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Rogelio (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Lonnie (She-Ra), Kyle (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Pre-Canon, Childhood Friends, First Meetings, The Fright Zone (She-Ra), Growing Up, Growing Up Together, Fluff and Angst, Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner's A+ Parenting, Implied/Referenced Child Abuse, Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Catra Needs Therapy (She-Ra)

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by higherfurtherfaster

Summary

"Let's go!" Adora giggles, crawling forward before looking back, waiting for the girl. She's just staring at Adora though, and she can't tell why she isn't following, but her eyes widen a second later when she understands. "Oh! You're not supposed to follow strangers.....I'm Adora! Now we aren't strangers," she giggles happily, the girl just staring, but she matches the sound Adora's making after a second, laughing as best she can.

(Adora and Catra, growing up in the Fright Zone together)

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Three Years Old

It’s Adora that finds Catra.

She’s really not supposed to be out here alone. Everything’s sharp and dark and mean, and last time she snuck out she scraped herself on a piece of metal and cried until Shadow Weaver found her.

Shadow Weaver wasn’t happy, and she used a mean word that Adora doesn’t know when she found her, but she hasn’t been allowed outside since. All the big kids are mean though and they took her ration bars and ripped them up all over her bed, so she doesn’t want to be inside anymore.

They were being mean to that new kid too, the one that looks like….Adora doesn’t know what he looks like, but his name is *really cool* . Rog….Rogmelsio, she thinks they call him, but she’s not sure. He can’t really talk yet, but Adora’s sure that he’ll tell her how to say it when he can.

She had to run away from the big kids, even if she didn’t like leaving Rogmelsio behind. The big kids would have been mean to her even more if she had stayed though, so she made a decision and ran outside where she doesn’t think that they’ll find her.

Instead, it’s Adora who finds something.

She’s not sure what it is at first. The Fright Zone is really smelly, and it’s all dark and sad, but the noises are usually more *clang clang* than *grrr* sounds.

Or sad crying noises.

“Hello?” Adora calls - Shadow Weaver says that she’s better at her words than any of the others in her class - stumbling a little as she almost trips over a piece of wood. The sounds get louder though - and sadder - so Adora thinks that she’s going in the right direction.

She’s smart like that, Shadow Weaver says.

“Are the big kids being big bullies to you too?” She continues, because she doesn’t like it when Rogmelsio is sad, and she doesn’t think this person should be all alone and sad either. “They’re mean to me too. They say I’m a…..a smeacher’s pet,” she parrots, not quite sure what it means, but they always laugh at her when they say it. “They’re just meanies though.”

The thing, wherever it is, doesn’t agree with her, but it makes a sound, and Adora’s brow furrows before her eyes widen a second later, a wide grin on her face. “Are you like my friend? He’s my best friend!” Adora grins, because it would be mean if the other thing could talk to her and isn’t. She sounds sad though, not mean, so that must be it!

“He can’t talk either,” she continues, eyes flitting around as she tries her best to walk in the dark, grinning as she uses her ‘awareness’ (Shadow Weaver calls it that) to avoid a crate in front of her.

Behind that crate though is a box, and Adora lets out a gasp as she looks inside.

“Are you….are you hair!?!?” She asks, intrigued and confused at the same time, reaching in to poke it. She doesn’t know anyone that’s just hair, but that only makes it cooler.

They aren’t just hair though, because they turn over onto their side and glare up at her, mismatched eyes staring into Adora’s blue. “Woah,” she says, never having seen that before either, and Adora can’t fall to her knees beside the box fast enough.

“What’s your name?” She asks, because even if he can’t talk yet, she knows Rogmelsio’s name at least. “The meanies call me bad names, so if I call you by your real name, then you’ll know I’m not being mean!”

Shadow Weaver says that she needs to work on her ‘strategic thinking’ but Adora thinks that was pretty smart.

The thing doesn’t say anything though, just whimpers and cries even more, turning onto it’s back. It looks like it’s trying to stand up, but it can’t, falling forward and hitting its chin on the side of the box before crumpling onto its stomach.

“Oh….” Adora gets out, face falling, because even if she’s okay with it, she was hoping that they’d be able to talk to her a little bit. “Can….I used to crawl when I was little…..could you do that?”

The girl doesn’t seem to understand though, just tilting its head as it sits on its butt, brushing hair out of her face. She accidentally scrapes herself with her hand though - she has knife hands! - yelping as she pulls her hand away from her face.

Adora really wants to help her, but she hasn’t learned first aid yet, so she thinks that the girl should do that when she goes inside. So instead, Adora just gets on her hands and knees, waiting for the girl to do the same.

Which she doesn’t, not exactly, but she gets on her hands and feet, so that’s a start.

“We should go inside! It’s cold,” Adora shivers, moving to stand up now that the girl is all steady. When she does though, the girl hisses at her - she has knife teeth too! - and Adora feels all confused again for a second.

“Am I too big?” She asks, and obviously the girl doesn’t say anything, just hissing at her, and Adora nods her head before she goes back to her hands and knees. “Better?” She questions, and the girl stops that sound she was making.

“C’mon!” Adora crawls around so that she’s facing the right way, waiting for the girl to get out of her box. “You look hurt, and Shadow Weaver can take care of you! She always takes care of me, so she’ll take care of you too,” Adora reasons - that’s her strategic thinking again - while waiting for the girl.

The girl waits a second before trying to get out, but her hair is in her face and she can’t see with it like that, and she misses the top of the box when she tries to get out. Instead, she lets out a cry as she falls forward, box tumbling with her, and Adora winces as she watches.

“Are….are you okay?” She asks, the girl crying again as she lays there, face on the ground. “It’s really dirty,” Adora reasons, not wanting to put her face on the ground of the Fright Zone, not understanding why the girl isn’t getting up right away.

Thankfully she does eventually, getting onto her hands and feet, looking at Adora. She’s covered in hair, but she’s not *all hair* , and Adora gives her a wide toothy grin.

“Let’s go!” She giggles, crawling forward before looking back, waiting for the girl. She’s just staring at Adora though, and she can’t tell why she isn’t following, but her eyes widen a second later when she understands. “Oh! You’re not supposed to follow strangers……I’m Adora! Now we aren’t strangers,” she giggles happily, the girl just staring, but she matches the laugh Adora’s making after a second, even if it’s a little weird sounding.

“C’mon slowpoke,” Adora grins, crawling forward again, the girl following her a second later before quickly catching up so that they can make their way inside.

Together.

Four Years Old

Chapter Summary

Adora can’t stop bouncing up and down on the balls of her feet as she waits outside the room.

Her friend is in there - should be in there - but she’s usually out by now, ready to play with Adora. Even when she looks tired, or when she looks sad (sometimes she looks really sad) she’s always ready to play with Adora.

(Catra and Adora's second year together)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora can’t stop bouncing up and down on the balls of her feet as she waits outside *the room* .

Her friend is in there - should be in there - but she’s usually out by now, ready to play with Adora. Even when she looks tired, or when she looks sad (sometimes she looks really sad) she’s always ready to play with Adora.

It’s been just over a year since Adora found her and brought her new best friend to Shadow Weaver and the infirmary, and she’s seen her every day since. She had always thought that Rogelio - she’s realized that she was saying his name wrong, because Shadow Weaver told her so - would be her best friend, but he hangs out with that new recruit more, Lonnie.

Lonnie can be a little mean sometimes, but Adora thinks she'll be a good cadet when they become them together. Still, Lonnie and Rogelio spend almost as much time together as Adora and her new best friend, so she's happy that Rogelio has a friend like that, even if it isn't Adora.

Adora still doesn't know her friend's name yet, but she has tons of ideas about what it could be. She's learned that she's a cat - she doesn't know what cats are, but she knows that her friend is one - and that a nickname for cats is 'Kitty'. She wants to name her Kitty, but Shadow Weaver says not to name her and to not get too attached, so she hasn't called her Kitty to her face yet.

Shadow Weaver calls her *thing* , but Adora doesn't think that's her real name, so she doesn't call her that either.

So when she's talking to Lonnie or Rogelio, she just calls Kitty her 'Best Friend' instead of a name, which works for now. She can understand a bit more, Kitty, and she can talk a little bit, but it's still hard for her. She sounds all weird to Adora, like she's supposed to be talking like something else, but Adora doesn't know what that could be, since everyone who talks in the Fright Zone talks like her.

Still, she's taking a long time in *the room* , and Adora really wants to run around outside and play 'Force Captain' together before they have their ration bars for dinner. So she goes up to the door and knocks, assuming that Kitty might have just fallen asleep in there and needs to be woken up.

Adora doesn't know where she sleeps, but she's always in this room, so it must be where Kitty sleeps, she thinks.

Instead of Kitty, she hears Shadow Weaver's voice, Adora's eyes widening as she quickly runs back to the opposite wall, standing with good posture, just like Shadow Weaver always says to. She's not sure what posture is yet, but it means keeping your back straight and your head high, and she can do that easily enough.

"What is it?!" Shadow Weaver says as she opens the door, not sounding happy at all, although she does sigh as she sees Adora there. "Oh… *Adora* ," she says, in that way that always makes Adora feel like she's done something wrong and can do better, even if she doesn't know what.

"Hi Shadow Weaver," she says, making sure that she keeps her posture. "Is Kit….is she in there? We were gonna play."

Shadow Weaver sighs though, sounding **disappointed** (Adora knows that's a bad word), but she does look back in the room before going back to Adora. "I *suppose* she can be done for the day. There are such better choices for friends, Adora. This one is….this *thing* is **vile** ."

Shadow Weaver makes that word sound bad, but Adora really really likes Kitty, so she doesn't know why she would say it like that.

“Can she play?” Adora asks again and Shadow Weaver just stares at her before walking into the room, Kitty coming out with her a second later. She looks tired, as tired as Adora thinks she’s ever seen her, and she’s tugging the sleeves of her shirt down to cover her arms. Her clothes are old clothes, and Adora can see that they’re full of holes and burns, but Kitty did get a long-sleeved shirt instead of the short ones, so it’s not too bad.

Adora doesn’t know why she’s tugging down her sleeves though, because it’s kind of warm today, but she’s too happy to see Kitty to think more about it.

“Hi!” Adora chirps happily, Shadow Weaver just groaning softly before she leaves, Kitty jumping as the door slams shut behind her.

“Fr….fr….friend,” Kitty gets out, and Adora grins happily, it not taking nearly as long as it used to. “Ad….Adora.”

“That’s me!” Adora giggles, waiting for Kitty to get down on all fours before running outside together. Kitty’s better at standing on her feet than she was, but running can be hard, especially when she’s tired, so Adora doesn’t mind as much that she walks like that when it’s just the two of them.

Plus, Kitty’s *fast,* and she always gets there before Adora. Adora is getting better though, getting faster, and they don’t take long to get there, always eager to play.

Their play area outside is empty, like it usually is, Adora giggling as she goes to their secret crate. She takes out the wooden practice stun baton that she uses when they play 'Force Captain', the princess dummies still set up in the corner.

"Ready?" Adora grins, having been waiting for this all day, although her face falls as she turns around.

Kitty's sitting on her butt, her sleeve pulled up as she licks at her arm, and Adora's brow furrows. "What….we're gonna play," she gets out, not sure what's going on, but Kitty ignores her as she keeps licking at…. *something*

"What is that?" Adora asks as she comes closer, her wooden stun baton forgotten as she sits cross legged in front of her best friend.

Kitty doesn't stop licking though, not until Adora leans in to look, the hiss that escapes her being almost instantaneous.

Adora tries not to feel sad though, because Kitty acts like that sometimes, and it's like she doesn't even try to do it. It just sort of happens.

"Fr…friend," Kitty gets out, quicker this time, and Adora can't help her smile as she nods. Kitty's voice still sounds weird - like if Adora were hearing her over one of those radio things and it was

all messed up - but she's getting better, and Adora knows she'll be able to talk as well as her in no time.

"Friend," Adora agrees, reaching out again, and Kitty gives her arm one last lick before letting Adora see.

"Shad….Shadow….not….not fri…..not friend," Kitty says, and Adora's even more confused now, because even if Shadow Weaver's not her friend like Kitty is, she's still not *not* her friend.

The thing on Kitty's arm is weird with all her fur, but Adora thinks that it looks a lot like how she gets when she hurts herself in training. Which is weird, because Kitty just sleeps in her room all day, and Adora doesn't think she's ever been at training.

"You sleep weird," Adora says under her breath, not sure what else it could be, and before she can stop herself she leans in, licking at it just like Kitty was.

Which gets her a mouthful of fur, and she just coughs and tries to spit it out, Kitty laughing at her troubles.

It stops a second later though and Kitty looks at her weird again, reaching forward to tap Adora's shoulder while trying to be careful of her claws. "Ad….Adora….Name….Adora," she says, and Adora nods, pretty sure that there's no more fur in her mouth.

“My….my name…” she continues, and this is the hardest question Adora’s ever had to answer, because she really doesn’t know this one. It’s not like when she gets a question wrong in studying and Shadow Weaver just says that she isn’t trying hard enough, because she really *doesn’t know* this one.

“I….we can make it together!” She grins, happy with her quick thinking, and Kitty just tilts her head at her. Adora thinks about calling her Kitty, but it is *Kitty’s name* , so she should probably think about it herself. “What do you want to be called?” Adora asks next, play time forgotten for something far more interesting.

“C…..Cat….” Kitty says, tapping her chest, and Adora nods, smiling wide. “Ad…Adora,” she continues, tapping Adora’s chest now. “Cat….Catdora….Cat…Catra.”

“Catra,” Adora reasons, tapping her chin and running it through in her head. “I like it! Catra and Adora!”

Kitty - not Kitty, **Catra** - makes that noise that she makes when Adora says it, the one that sounds like when a skiff starts, bouncing up and down as she sits there.

“Cat…..Catra and…..And…..Adora,” Catra says, and Adora just grins, the two of them sharing wide happy smiles before they scramble to their feet, Adora grabbing her wooden stun baton as Catra gets on all fours, charging at the princesses.

“Catra…..” Adora says to herself, giggling happily before she charges forward with her stun baton ready to strike, all while Catra bites at the foot of one of the princesses.

Chapter End Notes

I intend for Friday to be the next update!

Five Years Old

Chapter Summary

> “She’ll be your responsibility Adora.”
>
> “Yes Shadow Weaver,” Adora says, doing her best to contain her excitement. “We’ll be good. Promise.”
>
> “It’s not you that I’m concerned about,” Shadow Weaver continues, hand gripping the back of Catra’s shirt just a little bit tighter. “She knows what will happen if she doesn’t behave like a proper girl.”
>
> (At five years old, Adora finally gets her bunkmate)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“She’ll be your responsibility Adora.”

“Yes Shadow Weaver,” Adora says, doing her best to contain her excitement. “We’ll be good. Promise.”

“It’s not you that I’m concerned about,” Shadow Weaver continues, hand gripping the back of Catra’s shirt just a little bit tighter. “She knows what will happen if she doesn’t behave like a proper girl.”

“Yes Shadow Weaver,” Adora says again, eyes doing their best to stay on Shadow Weaver, but she can’t help looking at Catra a second later.

Catra, who looks scared for some reason.

She looks happy, but she looks scared too, and Adora doesn’t understand why because they’re finally going to be bunkmates.

Shadow Weaver says that Catra's too old and not worth the effort of having her own room now (Adora understands the first part but not the second) and she can act enough like the 'normal girls' that she won't have problems with the other kids and is ready to join them permanently.

She can talk pretty much no problem, just taking a little bit longer to think about some words. Plus, she can stand on two feet just as well as Adora, and she's learned how to fully sheath her claws now.

Today is all that Adora's wanted for the past two years, to be able to see Catra even more than she already does. Because now they can play 'Force Captain' whenever they want, and not just when Catra is done with her special classes.

"Good…." Shadow Weaver finishes, giving one last look at Catra before she pushes her forward, Catra stumbling a bit before she catches herself. She doesn't have any bags, just the clothes she's wearing, but Adora's pretty sure that's the only pair of clothes she's ever seen Catra wear.

Because she can see the little rips from Catra's claws when they were smaller and she didn't know how to put them away yet, so she kept accidentally putting her claws through her shirt.

Shadow Weaver leaves them alone though - Lonnie and Rogelio are with another new recruit, Kyle - and Adora runs forward to grab Catra's hand.

"C'mon!" She giggles excitedly, and Catra stumbles along with her the extra few feet to their new bunk. "You can have the top bunk," Adora smiles wide, although her face falls when she turns to Catra. "Do….do you want the bottom?" She asks, because Catra looks sad again, and Adora's worried that she doesn't actually want to be bunkmates.

"Top….top is fine," Catra gets out, voice sounding more normal to Adora's ears after learning how to speak the past year, but even

now it’s just a little bit lower.

“I just….Shadow Weaver’s going to be mean to you.”

Adora’s confused by that, because Shadow Weaver might be mean sometimes, but it’s always because she wants Adora to be the best.

“We’ll be good. Just like I said!” Adora reasons, because then Shadow Weaver will have no reason to be mean, and Catra can be happy to be bunkmates, just like how she was happy when Shadow Weaver told them yesterday.

“She’ll still be mean,” Catra grumbles, picking at her sleeve - she’s growing a little, so it only goes to just above her wrist now - not meeting Adora’s eyes.

“We’ll just be extra good then,” Adora reassures, because she never wants Catra to be sad, especially on a happy day like this. “I don’t know what kind of bed you’ve been sleeping on, but this is the only bed I’ve ever had, and I really like it!”

“Bed…..mine was on the floor,” Catra says, and that really confuses Adora, because she’s never seen a bed that was on the floor before. “This….this thing,” she gestures, Catra pointing at Adora’s blanket, and that’s even more confusing.

“You….you just had a blanket?” She asks, and Catra mutters the word under her breath, like she’s memorizing it. “Oh….we must not have had any one person beds for you. Just bunks,” Adora reasons, because Shadow Weaver would obviously give Catra a bed if there was one for her to use. “You have one now though!”

At that, Adora steps back so Catra can approach, and she watches her best friend sniff at the top bunk before hopping up. It always amazes Adora that Catra can do that, as well as all the other cool things that she can do that Adora can’t, and it only makes her think about how special Catra is, because there’s no one like her.

“Do you like it?” Adora asks, coming closer, watching Catra sniff the mattress and do little circles on it, like she’s trying to understand how it feels. “You can take the bottom if you want.”

“No….I like to….to climb,” Catra says, taking a second to find the word. “Can you….” she stops and starts, and Adora can tell that she’s a little embarrassed right now, because she’s red in her face in the same way that Adora can get sometimes.

Adora likes it. She thinks it makes Catra look pretty.

“Can you….come up?” She finally asks, and Adora smiles wide, because that’s an easy thing to do. “You….you’re safe. Make me feel safe. So….smells like you…”

“That means it's safe,” Adora reasons, Catra nodding. “Of course, silly,” Adora giggles before she clambers up, not nearly as graceful as Catra. She lays on her back and spreads out her arms and legs wide, giggling as she takes up as much space as she can while not messing up Catra. “Like that?”

Catra just takes a couple little sniffs and nods before curling up into Adora’s side, resting her head on her stomach. “Like that,” she says, and she makes that loud rumbling sound again, closing her eyes as she lays there.

Shadow Weaver always says not to touch each other, but she’s not here, and Adora wants her best friend to feel good and happy about living together and being bunkmates, so she decides to be a little rebellious.

She doesn’t do that a whole lot, only when it helps Catra.

So she rests one of her hands on Catra’s back, feeling Catra stiffen for a second before she sighs, closing her eyes again. “Is that okay?” Adora asks, voice quiet, and Catra just makes that noise even louder, Adora smiling softly as she closes her eyes for a second.

They stay like that for a while, Adora spread out with Catra curled against her side sleeping. They stay like that until Rogelio and Lonnie come back with the other new recruit, and Adora can’t help how excited she is to finally introduce them to her bestest friend.

Chapter End Notes

So I think I've determined that the schedule will be every Monday and Friday!

Hope you all liked it :)

Six Years Old

Chapter Summary

> "Catra! I didn't mean to hit you that hard!"
>
> Adora can't help the way that her heart is beating out of her chest as she scampers around the Fright Zone, trying her best to find Catra. At first, she thought that she'd be like she usually is when she gets sad or cries, when she just hides under her blanket and hopes that no one says anything, but she wasn't there this time.
>
> Maybe because it was Adora that hurt her.
>
> (Catra and Adora start their cadet training together)

"Catra! I didn't mean to hit you that hard!"

Adora can't help the way that her heart is beating out of her chest as she scampers around the Fright Zone, trying her best to find Catra. At first, she thought that she'd be like she usually is when she gets sad or cries, when she just hides under her blanket and hopes that no one says anything, but she wasn't there this time.

Maybe because it was Adora that hurt her.

Maybe she doesn't want to be friends with Adora anymore.

That sends a shiver down Adora's spine and almost brings tears to her eyes, because she wants to be Catra's friend forever and ever, so she can't ever imagine them not being best friends.

Adora didn't even want to fight Catra, not really. They're starting their cadet training though, and Shadow Weaver paired them up herself, because Kyle still doesn't know how to fight and Lonnie and Rogelio were already together.

So, Catra and Adora fought as part of their training, and it was really fun at first! They've always play fought, ever since Catra could walk on two feet, so they were giggling and having fun together, like they always do. Catra just dodged all of Adora's punches, because even if she can sheathe her claws now, there were enough times when they were little where she accidentally scratched Adora that she's scared to do it now, even still.

Adora knows that Catra would never mean to hurt her though. Never ever.

Shadow Weaver wasn't happy though, and she said that Adora would never be a cadet if she didn't fight like she wanted to kill.

Adora would never want to kill Catra, so she couldn't fight her quite like that, but Shadow Weaver looked so mad and before Adora knew what she was doing, she punched Catra hard.

Hard enough that Catra fell to the ground, and before Adora could ask if she was okay, Catra was running away. Shadow Weaver said not to go after her though, no matter how much Adora wanted to, so it's only just now that she's actually able to go out and look for her.

Lost in her thoughts, Adora finds herself in the same place that she was three years ago, the very first time that she ever saw Catra. It's pretty much the same - no one goes over here, and that's probably why no one found Catra before her - and that's why, as soon as she hears the sniffles, she knows exactly where to go.

"Catra?" Adora calls, making her way to that crate that Catra's box was behind when they first met, hoping that she'll find her best friend there.

The box is still there, and even if Catra's too big now, she's stuffed herself inside it, and it takes all of Adora's being not to giggle at the sight and how cute it is. Catra doesn't like it when people call

her that stuff though - she used to, but she doesn't anymore - so Adora just stays quiet, kneeling beside the box.

"Catra…..are you…."

"You hit me……you said that we'd never hurt each other."

Catra can speak just as good as Adora now - sometimes better than Adora - and she's definitely smarter too. She's good at all that stuff that Adora isn't, and she's good at fighting.

Sometimes Adora doesn't understand why Shadow Weaver doesn't see that Catra's just as good as her.

"I'm sorry," Adora gets out, wiping her eyes quickly as she sits there, rubbing her arm nervously. "Sh….Shadow Weaver said that I needed to fight you if I wanted to be a cadet, and I….I had to, Catra."

"You didn't," Catra reiterates before she moves to sit up, and Adora can't help her gasp. Because even if the fur covers it up a little bit, there's a big bruise on Catra's cheek, and there's really no question where it came from.

"Whatever, Adora," Catra sniffles, because even if she tries to be all cool and tough like the older kids, Adora knows that Catra still gets sad a lot of the time. "It doesn't matter…..you can go laugh with Lonnie about how I ran away or something."

"I would never do that," Adora frowns, looking at the bruise for a second before her big brain comes up with an idea on how to make it better. "Don't move," she says as she leans in, puckering her lips the second before she presses them to Catra's bruise.

"What…..are you…..doing?" Catra gets out, not really sounding mad, more confused, but her other cheek is red now too when Adora pulls away. "What was that?"

"I...you're always licking yourself when you're hurt," Adora reasons, because she thinks it's actually pretty smart, and she

knows that Catra will too once she explains it. “So I thought I could...lick it better.”

“You didn’t lick it though,” Catra reasons, and Adora knows that she’s right, because she’s not really sure what she did. She knows that when she’s licked Catra before she’s just gotten a mouthful of fur though, so she didn’t want to do that, and just did what she did instead. “You did….something dumb.”

Adora giggles at that, because it means that Catra isn’t mad at her, not anymore.

“I promise I’ll never hit you again. Even if Shadow Weaver tells me too,” she promises, and Catra looks down at her hands in her lap, shaking her head.

“If we’re sparring again, you’ll have to,” she reasons, and Adora knows that she’s right, because Catra’s just that smart. “Just….not as hard? You hit me really hard.”

“I promise,” Adora says, no hesitation. It was an instinct, and she hates that she did it, more than she’s ever hated anything ever.

“I would have beaten you if I’d been ready,” Catra counters, and Adora giggles, watching as her best friend jumps out of her box and onto the crate before landing on her feet beside Adora. “Bet I can beat you back to the bunks.”

“Nuh uh!” Adora argues - she knows Catra will beat her in a race, but it’s always fun to try to win - before she scrambles to her feet, racing off after Catra as they laugh and laugh.

Seven Years Old

Chapter Summary

"Get away from her!"

Adora's been getting taller and stronger ever since Shadow Weaver made them all cadets and let them start to train properly, but she's still not as strong as the bigger kids, so they don't have any problem swatting her away when she rushes forward.

(Catra gets bullied, and Adora does her best to help)

"Get away from her!"

Adora's been getting taller and stronger ever since Shadow Weaver made them all cadets and let them start to train properly, but she's still not as strong as the bigger kids, so they don't have any problem swatting her away when she rushes forward.

"Scram," one of them says, the others laughing, and Adora pouts as she rubs her butt, having fallen to the ground harder than she had expected. That doesn't matter though, especially when Catra's hissing and growling where she's surrounded by the bigger kids.

They've always been mean to Catra, teasing her about her ears and her tail and her fur. They were even worse when Catra was younger - Adora knows they would have been awful those first few years, but no one knew Catra besides Adora and Shadow

Weaver then - in the time right after Catra joined Adora, Lonnie, Rogelio and Kyle in the bunks.

They'd tease her about how sometimes she'd forget what she was 'supposed to do' and would run around on all fours because it was more natural for her, or sometimes she'd mewl or meow when she was happy, because it was her natural instinct.

Catra works really hard not to do that stuff now though. Which makes Adora sad, because she really loved all those little things about Catra.

Even with how hard Catra works on being a 'proper girl' (Shadow Weaver says that) she still gets teased about the little things that she can't control. The way her ears twitch when she hears Adora's voice, or the way that her tail will thump and sway when she and Adora are playing and happy.

The reason the big kids are being meanies today though is that Catra hissed at a mouse that snuck into the cafeteria and couldn't help herself from trying to catch it. The older kids saw that though, and one of them caught the mouse a couple minutes, teasing Catra with it and making a circle with her and the mouse in it, and now she can't get out.

The mouse is gone now, having scampered away, but Catra's still surrounded by the big kids and she can't escape. She could use her claws and her fangs, but Shadow Weaver would get really mad about that, so she can't really do anything but growl.

Adora knows that Catra will use her claws eventually once she's past the point of caring, but she really doesn't want that to happen because she never wants Catra to get in trouble.

Catra, who's trying to do her best not to cry right now, and is instead just hissing on all fours as she tries to get away from the big kids, but that's only making them laugh and tease her even more.

"She can't even stand up," one of them laughs, and that's just not true, because Catra can stand on two feet now, no problem. It's just that when she's scared, she forgets about that and goes back to what's natural for her, and that's to be on all fours.

Adora's recovered now, and she takes a breath, quickly deciding what to do. She'll get in trouble too, but she won't get in as much trouble as Catra if she were to bite them - Adora doesn't quite understand why she gets in less trouble, but she knows that that's true - so it only takes a second before she runs forward, shouldering into the back of one of the big kid's knees.

Adora's low enough that the big kid topples forward into one of the other ones, and Catra can run out, speeding away as fast as she can. Adora can't keep up when she runs that fast, but she knows Catra's spots - she's started going to them instead of hiding under her blanket in the past year - and when she's *really really* sad, there's only one place that she goes.

So Adora runs as fast as she can, because the big kids will be mad at her too, and it's a couple minutes later that she finds the supply closet that no one uses, closing the door behind her.

"Catra?" She calls, because it's too dark for Adora to see, and she doesn't want to be stupid and trip or fall.

She just gets a hiss in response, and that really could only be Catra. It also means that she's still mad and upset, because she's not speaking. She's hissing, like she would have done when she and Adora had first met.

The thing that makes her different. The things that Adora loves most about her, but everyone else makes fun of her for.

"They were being stupid, Catra," Adora continues, feeling her way around. She's doing it in front of her though, not at her feet, and for that reason it's a surprise when she walks into something small, sad, and furry.

Catra's still not quite recovered though either, and Adora lets out a yelp of surprise when she's tackled to the ground. She can't see, but it's obvious that it's Catra, and that she's still in her almost feral state.

"Catra!" Adora squeaks out, voice sounding even younger than she is, even at seven years old. "Catra it's me. It's Adora!"

As soon as she says her name though, Catra stops, the hands on Adora's shirt stilling. Her claws are out, digging in just enough that Adora thinks it could prick the skin underneath, but she also knows that would only make Catra feel worse, and that's what she's trying to avoid.

"Adora?" Catra asks, like she's coming back to herself, and it's only a second later that she's scrambling away from Adora, back hitting the opposite wall with a thud. "What….what are you doing here?"

"I wanted to check on you," Adora says, quickly, still unable to see where Catra is, but able to breathe a sigh of relief at knowing that she's safe. "They were being really mean to you."

"Because I'm different," Catra gets out, almost like a curse, and Adora's brow furrows at the tone. "Because I'm…."

"Because they're stupid," Adora offers, but even she can tell in the dark that Catra's thinking something else right now.

Like maybe she's the problem, not them. Or who she is - *what she is* - is what's wrong, and Adora really doesn't like that.

"Yeah," Catra sighs, clenching her fist, the little seven year old slumping back against the wall. "It's their fault, not mine."

Even at their age, Adora can tell that Catra doesn’t quite believe that.

Eight Years Old

Chapter Summary

Adora can tell that something's been different with Catra.

It's like Catra just….Adora's not even sure how to describe it.

She's just a little different now.

(Adora thinks about how Catra's changed, and they have a sleepover)

Adora can tell that something's been different with Catra.

It's like Catra just….Adora's not even sure how to describe it.

She's just a little different now.

Ever since that day with the bigger kids, she's been more….

Adora's still not great with her big words sometimes, so she just decides to say that Catra's *different.*

She doesn’t purr anymore, or at least Adora can’t remember a time where she purred for more than a couple seconds. It usually only happens when they’re alone in bed whispering about whatever happened that day, that Catra starts to purr just a little bit.

She stops herself as soon as she realizes what's happening though, which makes Adora really sad. She loves Catra’s purr, because she loves when Catra’s happy, and her purr tells Adora when she’s happy.

Which she doesn’t do anymore.

Her tail has stopped lashing around as much too. It was another way that Adora knew that Catra was happy, because the louder it hit the ground and swayed around, the more excited Catra was. It doesn’t happen now though, if at all.

Adora was worried that it meant that Catra just wasn’t happy - wasn’t happy being Adora’s friend - but like her purr, she always stops herself from doing it when her tail starts tapping against the ground.

Her ears still twitch sometimes, at least. Adora doesn’t think that Catra can control that, not like she can control her purr or her tail, so at the very least, she lets herself feel that much.

It just scares Adora, that Catra's changing a little bit. Shadow Weaver says that everyone changes as they get older, but Adora doesn't want Catra to change that much. She'll get big, sure, but Adora hopes that why they're best friends doesn't change. Because Catra's funny, and smart and fun and *so cool.* Plus, all her cat stuff - Adora's learned what a cat is now - is partially why Adora finds her so awesome.

She can do stuff that no one else can, which is part of why Adora likes her so much. She's stopping some of that stuff though, which makes Adora sad.

Right now, it's late at night, the two of them in Adora's bunk. Catra usually sleeps there three nights out of every five, but she moves to near Adora's feet when she's ready to go to bed.

Adora usually falls asleep first, with Catra beside her, but she's always down at her feet when she wakes up.

Sometimes Adora wishes that Catra would stay beside her so that she was the first thing that she sees in the morning.

She's not quite sure why, but she just knows that she gets all warm and fuzzy whenever she thinks about it. Shadow Weaver would say that that's a weakness, feeling that feeling, but Adora doesn't think that it could ever be, not when it makes her feel that good.

"Did you see that boy that tried to talk to Lonnie today?" Adora whispers, and Catra has to bring her hand to her mouth to contain

her cackle, shaking her head. “He told Lonnie that he thought she was pretty.”

“ *Lonnie?”* Catra asks, just keeping out the laughter from her voice, and Adora just giggles as well as she nods her head. They’re still young, but since they’re cadets now, they’re around the older kids a bit more - not that the older kids want them there - but Adora knows words like pretty and sexy now, because of them.

She doesn’t know what sexy is exactly, but she knows that it means that you’re even prettier than pretty.

Adora thinks that she might think that Catra is sexy. She’s not quite sure though.

“What happened?” Catra asks, because even if they’re usually together, Catra had to go to extra practice at lunch because she almost failed her weapons training two days ago. She’s usually so good with weapons too, but for some reason she was slow then, and Catra’s never slow.

“Lonnie punched him in the face,” Adora giggles, and this time Catra can’t help her cackle. She’s quick to bring her hand to her mouth, but the sound still gets out, Catra’s eyes wide as she quickly looks around.

No one does anything, because they're all asleep, but Catra doesn't seem to think that things are okay. Her eyes are wide and she looks like she thinks that she did something wrong, even if Adora can't figure out what it could be.

"He had to go to the infirmary," Adora clarifies, figuring she'll just keep going with the story, because Catra seemed really happy when she was hearing it, and Adora wants her to be happy again. "Lonnie didn't get in trouble, because he was trying to 'fraternize' with her, and Lonnie didn't do anything wrong. At least that's what Shadow Weaver said."

Catra looks away when Adora mentions Shadow Weaver, and Adora curses herself for saying her name. She's seeing more and more that Shadow Weaver is mean to Catra for no reason - no reason at all - and she's starting to understand why Catra doesn't like Shadow Weaver that much.

"She broke his nose," She interjects, and Catra cracks a smile at that, so Adora knows that she's doing something right. "And he's not allowed the grey ration bars for a month….which means more for us!" She grins, and Catra laughs at that one again, quietly so.

She starts to purr too, but she cuts it off a second later, and Adora does her best to keep in her frown.

"Imagine getting beat up by *Lonnie* ," Catra says, looking behind them to where Lonnie's sleeping, and she giggles to herself. "Imagine getting beat up by *Kyle."*

It’s easy to make fun of Kyle, but it always works on Adora, and she just giggles and laughs as she shakes her head along with Catra.

“I can’t. I’m too tough,” Adora boasts, and Catra rolls her eyes at it this time. “And you’re too fast….he did beat Rogelio that time though.”

“Because Rogelio didn’t want Kyle to lose ration bars for a week. He didn’t really beat him,” Catra clarifies, and Adora’s eyes widen, because she hadn’t realized that.

“Oh….that makes sense.”

“You’re such an idiot,” Catra teases, and Adora grins at that before launching into a story about how Kyle almost stubbed his toe when he got scared by a mouse.

They talk like that for hours before Adora falls asleep, Catra right beside her.

She’s at Adora’s feet when she wakes up.

Nine Years Old

Chapter Summary

> “Catra, you can’t just skip it!”
>
> “Shut up,” Catra mutters, curling in on herself even more, Adora’s brow furrowing as she watches her best friend.
>
> (Catra doesn't want to take a test, and Adora is confused)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“Catra, you can’t just skip it!”

“Shut up,” Catra mutters, curling in on herself even more, Adora’s brow furrowing as she watches her best friend.

It just….it doesn’t compute with her.

The idea that Catra might intentionally skip not just any class, but a *test* from Shadow Weaver herself is crazy, in Adora’s mind, and even if Catra says that she is, there’s no way that she’s okay.

Because Shadow Weaver is already mean to Catra, all the time, but she’ll be even meaner if Catra doesn’t go to this test.

“But…..but….It’s a test!” Adora argues, because that should really be all that she has to say, she thinks. It’s a theory test about battle plans and the best tactics to use in different terrains and it’s really important as part of finally becoming Force Captains together.

Well, not that they’ll become Force Captains anytime soon, because they’re still far too young, but they need to pass this test before they become Force Captains, whenever that’ll happen.

And Adora knows that they’ll become Force Captains together.

She knows that.

Catra must know it too, but she’s acting like she doesn’t, because she’s still in her bunk - she didn’t sleep at the foot of Adora’s last night - wrapped up in her blankets, hissing at Adora and shaking her head like a kitten.

“So? It’s not even a fighting test. It’s just….stupid books,” Catra grumbles, and that makes Adora even more confused. Catra always acts like she doesn’t like them, but Adora can tell that she likes books a lot, because she’s smart with them in a way that Adora has never been.

Adora can study and study as much as she wants - and she does study really hard - but she still gets the same scores as Catra, who only needs to read the books one time, if at all, before she

knows exactly what to say, and how to best act in a written scenario.

She just understands, and Adora can't do that, because she needs to know every possible tactic that could be used before she decides on the right one.

They're different in that way, and that's okay. It's better, even, because it means that Adora can teach Catra things that she might not know, and Catra can teach new ways of thinking to Adora too.

That doesn't mean that she can just skip the test though.

"Hordak always says that strategy and understanding the situation is when wars are won and lost," Adora parrots, and she knows immediately that that probably wasn't the right thing to say. She's not the best at the big words and understanding certain things yet, but she knows Catra.

And because she knows Catra, she knows that she doesn't like authority, or being told what to do, so saying the exact words that the authority wants probably isn't what she wants to hear. Or should hear, for that matter.

"And because Hordak says it…." Catra rolls her eyes, and this time Adora can't help her eyes widening, because that's **Hordak** that

Catra's talking about like that, and she could get in even more trouble if she doesn't listen to Hordak's laws.

"I just don't want to do the test, Adora. They can't make me," Catra continues, apparently set on this, even when she still hasn't told Adora why exactly she won't.

"I guess they can't…." Adora reasons, because if Catra really doesn't want to take it, she can probably just go somewhere that no one can find her and wait it out. "I just don't understand why you won't tell me."

Catra just frowns at that though, and Adora sighs, giving her best friend one last look before she turns and goes to the classroom, not wanting to miss the test herself.

Adora finishes the test as best as she can - while still making sure that she gets a really good grade, obviously - and as quickly as she can, so that she can go try to find Catra. She didn't come to the test, just like she said that she wouldn't, and Shadow Weaver was there, which makes it even worse.

Shadow Weaver didn't say anything, but she looked at Catra's seat next to Adora and scoffed. Which is worse, because she's not necessarily mad.

She expected it, Adora thinks. Or she's going to hurt Catra because she wasn't here, which is even scarier.

So Adora checks all the spots, and she doesn't find Catra. She doesn't know where she could be, because she's since told Adora about even her super secret spots - not where they are specifically, but just the kinda areas they're in - so Adora knows where to look at the very least.

She's not in those either though, so Adora has to give up eventually, because they have training tomorrow and she needs to eat if she wants to be able to do anything.

Catra doesn't show up to eat either, nor does she show up when Adora tucks herself into bed.

At least, she doesn't immediately.

She must wait until the time that Adora usually falls asleep, because it's then that she sneaks in, crawling up to her bunk.

"Catra?" Adora calls out, and she just hears a couple sniffles, Catra not saying anything in response.

"Catra?" Adora repeats, hoping that it'll work the second time.

It still doesn’t, but she can hear Catra scratching at herself, like there’s something under her fur that she’s trying really hard to get to. “Just go to bed, Adora,” Catra mutters, but she says it with such anger, in a way that Adora doesn’t think she’s ever heard Catra speak before.

Or at the very least never directed at her, because Catra’s angry a lot now.

“I just want to…..”

“Don’t,” Catra states firmly, and Adora just frowns, because she really wants to help, but Catra doesn’t want her to….

It’s too much for her young brain to wrap her mind around, so she just pouts instead, biting the inside of her cheek as she stops herself from helping.

She really really wants to, but for the first time in her life, Adora thinks that Catra might not want her.

At least not right now.

Chapter End Notes

Hi everyone!

I'm so so sorry about the long wait between chapters. School kind of kicked my ass for a little bit, so I wasn't able to write

too much. Then, since it had already been a bit, I figured I'd finish all the chapters and have them in editing all at once, so that I can keep a steady schedule with this.

So, they're all done, and I hope to get them out twice a week now :)

Ten Years Old

Chapter Summary

> "Keep up dummy!"
>
> Catra yells it back as they're racing through the halls of the Fright Zone, and Adora can't help but laugh, because it's been a long time since Catra was this happy.
>
> It's been a rough couple of years for her, Adora knows. She's getting better at understanding Catra's emotions when it comes to the Fright Zone, and she's quickly realizing that it's not all that nice to her best friend.
>
> Especially the last couple years.

> (Catra and Adora have a little race)

"Keep up dummy!"

Catra yells it back as they're racing through the halls of the Fright Zone, and Adora can't help but laugh, because it's been a long time since Catra was this happy.

It's been a rough couple of years for her, Adora knows. She's getting better at understanding Catra's emotions when it comes to the Fright Zone, and she's quickly realizing that it's not all that nice to her best friend.

Especially the last couple years.

Maybe it just took this long for it to affect her, or maybe Catra's just stopped hiding it, but she's a bit different now. A little meaner, both to Adora and to everyone else.

Everyone's always been mean to Catra, but she's being a little meaner back now. Which isn't necessarily a bad thing, Adora thinks, because she's just sticking up for herself and the Horde teaches them to be strong and tough, but sometimes she can take it just a *little bit* too far.

She's being a little bit meaner with Adora sometimes too.

Not usually on purpose, because Adora doesn't think that Catra would ever be mean to her on purpose. They're best friends, and will be forever, and best friends aren't ever mean to each other on purpose.

It's just sometimes, Catra can be a little….like she's sad, but she doesn't know how to be sad, so she's just mean instead.

Right now though, she's happy, and that's more than enough for Adora.

She thinks it might be enough for Catra too.

She’s doing her best to keep up, but Catra’s just too fast, and she really has no chance. The best way to get better though, is to try to beat the best, and Catra’s definitely the fastest in the Horde, without question.

She’s showing that right now, turning the corner as Adora can barely keep up. She’s lost a little bit of weight recently, her baby fat being well and truly gone, but she’s still working on her stamina just a little bit.

She quickly turns the corner though, doing her best not to skid too fast into the wall. She’s getting better at her corners, and she manages it, although she doesn’t see Catra when she starts down the hall again, and her brow furrows.

Catra’s fast but the hall is really long, and she’s not *that fast* that Adora would completely lose her that quickly. So Adora stops in her tracks then, trying to think of where Catra could have gone.

There’s a door on the side of the hallway though, and after a second, Adora decides to take a peek inside, just in case Catra’s in there for some reason. Adora’s not sure why, but it’s also the only thing that she can think of right now, and she’s getting better at her thinking skills.

So when Adora opens the door and she sees Catra pressed against the opposite wall, Adora feels a little thrill at knowing that she thought right. She might never be as smart as Catra, but she can be smart enough, even if she finds that harder to do than getting her body tougher.

“Catra, what are you….” Adora asks, but Catra just brings a finger to her lips, it being just bright enough she’s able to see despite there not being any light in the supply closet.

Adora doesn’t say anything after that though, just joining Catra against the wall as she tries to listen to whatever Catra’s ears have picked up on.

Adora never does hear it, but she can see the barest hint of shadows that sneak through the bottom of the door, so it isn’t hard to figure out who Catra must have heard talking to someone.

Shadow Weaver obviously knows that they play together, but she still gets mad whenever she catches them for some reason, which Adora just doesn’t understand.

Even at their young age, she knows not to say anything though, so she stays quiet until Catra deems it safe enough to move away from the wall, still not saying a word as she sneaks out of the supply closet, Adora quickly following.

“Catra….” Adora starts, but Catra’s already racing, even if Adora can’t quite tell if she’s running with or away from Adora.

She has no choice but to follow though, so Adora starts off running after Catra as best she can. Because they’re playing

though, and Adora always has fun playing with Catra, she can't help her laughter coming through, even after the worry and fear of Shadow Weaver potentially finding them.

She can hear Catra laughing down the hall, even as far in front of Adora as she is, so she must have forgotten about Shadow Weaver too.

Catra stops at their usual spot outside, that being as far as Adora can physically go. It's at the wall opposite of where they come out from the hallway, this wall probably being easy enough for Catra to climb, but Adora not quite knowing how to climb it herself.

She's still not skilled enough to, and she feels bad every time after they race when she sees Catra looking up at the sky, her dream of climbing it practically written across her face.

"You….you…." Adora tries to get out, taking deep breaths since she ran a bit harder than usual in that last little bit after Shadow Weaver, so as to not leave Catra alone for too long.

"You can climb it. If you want to," Adora offers, because even if Catra might feel bad about leaving Adora behind - and Adora might feel bad about being left behind - she can tell Catra needs this.

"You're sure?" Catra asks, and Adora smiles and nods, because it really is.

At that, Catra just grins in a way that Adora doesn’t think she has in years, giving Adora that wide toothy grin before she turns and starts to climb.

Eleven Years Old

Chapter Summary

> "You'll get it."
>
> "I just wish that it didn't hurt as much when I fall," Adora pouts as they lay there in bed, side by side.
>
> Her and Catra are having one of their sleepovers, having brought down Catra's pillow right now so that she could place it beside Adora's and that they can talk like this, facing each other.
>
> (Catra and Adora have one of their sleepovers, staying up all night and whispering about....you know, whatever)

"You'll get it."

"I just wish that it didn't hurt as much when I fall," Adora pouts as they lay there in bed, side by side.

Her and Catra are having one of their sleepovers, having brought down Catra's pillow right now so that she could place it beside Adora's and that they can talk like this, facing each other.

Their first sleepover they tried to do it with Catra at the foot of the bed like she usually sleeps, but that was too weird and it's too hard for Adora to hear Catra when she's down there.

This works so much better, but they always have to make sure that Catra's pillow is back up in her own bed when they wake up, and that Catra is either at the foot of Adora's bed or in her own.

It sucks, and it makes Adora sad, but it makes her feel even worse when Catra gets in trouble when they forget to do it, so she understands why they have to.

Even if she doesn't like it.

Adora had tried the climb to the roof again today, but she's still having trouble with it. They've set up cushions just underneath it, so the times that Adora falls, she has something to land on, and it's not like she's gotten up far enough yet to be hurt too bad when she does.

She got up farther today than she ever has, over halfway to the top, but she jumped too far to catch one of the handholds that Catra helped make for her, and she ended up tumbling back down to the ground.

Catra always does her best to catch her, and she did half-catch her today, enough that Adora lost a little bit of her momentum when she fell, but she still hit the cushion on the ground hard enough that it left a little bit of a bruise on her side.

Not bad enough that she can't hide it, and she's slender enough now that Shadow Weaver doesn't check on her weight too often,

so she really doesn't think that anybody but Catra will know about it.

Which is for the best, because if Shadow Weaver or any of their training instructors were to figure out that Adora was hurt, and then to find out how…..that she was trying to copy Catra….they'd be in big trouble.

Or Catra would be in big trouble, really.

That doesn't matter right now though, because Adora's favourite nights are their sleepover nights, and she doesn't want to ruin this with her worrying about the future right now.

"Well, it wouldn't hurt if you didn't fall, dummy," Catra snorts, and Adora can't help her giggle at that, all while she tries to actively stop herself from making any sounds. She manages, she thinks, because Catra's ears twitch just a little bit, but not as much as they usually do when Adora's too loud during their sleepovers.

"I'll get it...promise," Adora grins, because she truly believes that she will.

There's the physical component, obviously. Even if she's learning more and more about Shadow Weaver, she still wants to prove her right and be the best that the Horde has, and being able to climb to the roof that Catra loves so much is definitely a physical feat.

There’s also the part of her that never ever wants to let Catra down either, because she can tell how excited Catra is about maybe sharing her roof with Adora.

The fact that her tail is thumping lightly against the mattress is proof enough of that, it being something that she can’t hide at the moment.

“Good….I'm starting to feel sorry for you. Looking at you all alone down there, all slow and small and….”

“Okay okay,” Adora giggles again as she smacks Catra’s shoulder, just making Catra let out a quiet cackle of her own. “Don’t be a meanie about it. We can’t all be as cool as you,” Adora teases again, and even if Catra looks a little dubious, she’s in a teasing mood right now, so she clearly doesn’t want to undercut it or anything at the moment.

“No one can be as cool as me,” Catra just winks, and Adora rolls her eyes as she giggles still, feeling like she’s been doing it all night.

It’s been a good night.

“We should get another pillow. So you can leave yours up there and we have one just for sleepovers,” Adora reasons, and Catra

hums, snuggling a bit more into the one that she’s using right now. “When we’re Force Captains we can have sleepovers every night and not worry about moving pillows,” Adora continues, because everyone knows that Force Captains get their own rooms, and it’d be weird for Shadow Weaver or someone to go in every morning to check on them.

“Tell me again,” Catra says after a second, in a tone that Adora doesn’t quite understand. It’s not happy, although it is that too, but almost….it’s weird, to Adora’s ears. It’s a bit hopeful, but also a bit sad, and it doesn’t make sense, but Adora loves talking too much about when they'll be Force Captain’s together to think anything more about it.

“Well, Force Captains get their own rooms, obviously….and we can just ask for a big room together!” She starts, Catra’s eyes fluttering shut with a small smile on her face as she listens to Adora’s yarn.

Twelve Years Old

Chapter Summary

"You're almost here!"

Adora can't get out a response to Catra, because she's too focused on the extra little bit of effort that she needs to finally get to Catra's rooftop - their rooftop soon, she reminds herself - and falling right now would be….

It would be the worst thing that Adora can possibly think of.

She's wanted to be up here with Catra for two years now, and she's nearly there.

(Adora finally manages the climb)

"You're almost here!"

Adora can't get out a response to Catra, because she's too focused on the extra little bit of effort that she needs to finally get to Catra's rooftop - **their** rooftop soon, she reminds herself - and falling right now would be….

It would be the worst thing that Adora can possibly think of.

She's wanted to be up here with Catra for two years now, and she's nearly there.

Part of it is the knowledge that she's managed to climb this insurmountable thing, and that she's strong enough to do this. Shadow Weaver has been getting a little tougher on her now that she's old enough, but Adora knows that it's because Shadow Weaver just wants her to be the best she can be, and this is definitely part of that.

Not that she would tell Shadow Weaver about this, because she'd ask about all the other times Adora fell, and then she'd blame and hurt Catra for those.

The bigger part of Adora is excited though because this means that she can finally be up here *with Catra* .

Her most important person.

She wants Catra to be happy, always and forever, and she knows that this will make Catra happy, Adora being able to be up here and share this with her, Catra's special place. That now it'll be their special place, because even if it took a lot of effort, Adora knows that it'll get easier and easier each time that she tries to get up here.

"I...I made it," Adora groans as she gets that final push to the top, rolling onto her back after she's done it. "I finally made it," she

giggles, happy beyond belief.

"Only been waiting up here for two years," Catra teases, and Adora can't help her snort of laughter, even through the deep breaths she's taking. "Lucky that I waited for you."

"Yeah….lucky me," Adora giggles happily, because it is lucky of her, and she's still feeling too much euphoria about getting up here that she can't really bring herself to play their usual types of teasing games right now.

Adora can see Catra's gaze soften out of the corner of her eye, but Catra so rarely does that now, that even at this age, Adora isn't going to comment on it and ruin the moment.

"So...so where's this….this view that you always talk about?" Adora gets out, rolling over onto her stomach before she gets to her knees and eventually to her feet, stretching her arms out a little bit overhead.

It wasn't an easy climb, but Adora's always loved the little burn that she feels after a hard workout, and this is no exception.

"You actually have to be on the edge to see the view. If you can even walk after that climb," Catra smirks, and Adora rolls her eyes before she follows Catra to the other edge of the roof. Catra sits down on the edge with no trouble at all - not worried about falling off in the slightest - so even if Adora is a little bit nervous about

maybe falling off, she trusts Catra enough to know that she wouldn't have Adora sit on the edge if she was likely to fall.

"Wow," Adora gets out as she sits there, truly amazed by the view.

It's like nothing she's ever seen before.

She knows that the Whispering Woods are out there, obviously. She knows that the Princesses and Bright Moon are beyond it, and that the Princesses use it as protection so that they can hatch their evil plans in safety.

She's never seen it like this though. Able to see the entirety of it from above, to see the sky as untainted by the Fright Zone smoke as it possibly could be. It's beautiful, and even if it took her two years to get up here, Adora can tell that it was definitely worth the wait.

And that's not even mentioning that Catra's with her, right beside her.

Side by side, like they'll be *forever* .

"That's gonna all be ours someday," Adora fantasizes, able to see Catra turning to her out of her periphery. "We're gonna go through the Whispering Woods and take out the Princesses when we're Force Captains."

“You mean it?” Catra asks, surprisingly vulnerable, and Adora just turns to her with a wide smile, because even if they’ve talked about it before, it’s something entirely different when they can actually see what they’re going to be conquering together.

“Of course I mean it. I always mean it,” Adora smiles, and Catra smiles at that before it turns into a smirk.

“They’re not gonna know what hit them,” Catra cackles, and Adora just giggles along with her, because even if it’s fun thinking about all this on her own, it’s even more fun when it’s her and Catra doing it together.

Because it’s Adora’s dream sure, but it’s not much of a dream if it isn’t with Catra.

Because Catra complements Adora in every way, and no matter what Shadow Weaver says, Adora knows that she’s so much more stronger when she’s with Catra instead of alone.

“How do you think we’ll get through the Whispering Woods?” Adora asks, because Catra’s *so good* at thinking of stuff like this. She’s a lot more creative in ways that, although they might not be actual battle plans, they’re really fun to think about.

“Well……obviously we’ll need a flamethrower to burn down the Woods first. A *really big* flamethrower,” Catra starts, and Adora

just grins wide as she nods, looking between the Whispering Woods and her best friend.

Thirteen Years Old

Chapter Summary

It’s around when she’s thirteen years old that Adora starts to realize that her feelings for Catra are different.

Well, that’s not entirely true.

She’s known that she likes Catra more than she likes everyone else for a while now.

(Adora reflects on how she feels about Catra)

It’s around when she’s thirteen years old that Adora starts to realize that her feelings for Catra are different.

Well, that’s not entirely true.

She’s known that she likes Catra more than she likes everyone else for a while now. That’s not really a surprise, since Catra’s her best friend for a reason, and it would be weirder if Adora didn’t like Catra as much as she does.

But she’s only just learning that she likes Catra more than….more than as a best friend.

She wants to spend every second that she possibly can with Catra. She wants Catra to stay in her bed the entire night, and not

at the foot of it. She wants Catra by her side at all times, and she wants Catra to hold her hand more.

They hold hands sometimes when they're up on the rooftop, but Catra never looks at their hands when they do.

It's really nice though, the feeling of holding hands. To feel Catra like that, and for longer than just a second, is *really really nice* .

Adora's tried to hold hands a couple times since then, when they aren't on the roof. Like they used to when they were kids, skipping and laughing together as they made their ways through the halls of the Fright Zone together. They always held hands then, because they were each other's protection from the big kids, and they just didn't consider *not* holding hands.

That changed after Shadow Weaver saw them though, and Adora didn't get to hold Catra's hand again for years.

Not until the rooftop.

Adora tried to do it when they were walking to go eat dinner, making sure that they were the only two people in the hall when she did. They were just talking about training earlier that day - Kyle had tripped over his own feet and given himself a black eye - so Adora reached over for Catra's hand, trying to get it in hers.

Catra didn’t say anything, but she looked down for a split second before pulling her hand away, changing the topic to talk about how much of a dummy Adora was the other day when she fell out of bed from sleep-fighting too hard.

Catra didn’t say anything, but Adora got the message loud and clear.

That really made her realize that she thinks about Catra differently than a best friend.

Because if they were just best friends, Adora wouldn’t feel as sad as she does about not holding hands. Best friends don’t really hold hands when they’re big kids - Kyle and Rogelio never hold hands with each other or Lonnie - but Adora’s seen some of the things that the even bigger kids sneak in, the books that aren’t textbooks, and she’s seen people holding hands in those.

People who aren’t best friends, but are something more.

Adora doesn’t know what you would call that something more, because she’s only seen those books in secret and never actually read them, but she just knows that they definitely aren’t best friends.

Best friends also don’t feel as happy as she does right now, Catra snuggled up at her feet, snoring softly. She always falls asleep first when she’s already down at Adora’s feet - Catra says it’s easy

for her to fall asleep, but Adora knows that isn't always true - and that means that Adora just gets to watch her for a minute.

Catra looks so pretty when she's all relaxed.

She's never really relaxed though, anymore. Catra used to be all happy and always wanting to play, but she isn't like that now. She still plays with Adora, but she always makes Adora ask first, and the times that she doesn't, she makes it seem like it's Adora's idea.

She doesn't smile a lot anymore either, and never when she's with someone else that isn't Adora.

Adora loves Catra's smile, more than anything.

The final clue for her is the way that her heart is beating out of her chest right now as she watches Catra and thinks all these things about her, about how much she likes and cares for her.

Adora knows that you're not allowed to be….more than best friends in the Horde though, especially at their age. Or, Shadow Weaver hasn't given them that lesson yet about being best-best friends - Adora thinks that name works for now - but she knows it exists for the older kids.

Adora just doesn’t understand why it could ever be a bad thing though.

She guesses that it kind of makes sense that you wouldn’t want to be distracted when fighting Princesses, but she also knows that she’d work even harder and be even more careful so that she can help keep Catra safe.

Not that Catra needs to be kept safe, because she can take care of herself, but Adora would just want to help too, is all.

She thinks there must be other reasons that they can’t be best-best friends that she just doesn’t know about. Shadow Weaver knows a lot more than Adora does, so there must be something bad about it, but…..Adora doesn’t know what it could be .

All she knows right now is that she just feels really happy here with Catra, and she doesn’t understand how that could ever be a bad thing.

She doesn’t think anything with Catra could ever be a bad thing.

Especially right now, with Catra purring softly at Adora’s feet, looking all relaxed and happy.

Fourteen Years Old

Chapter Summary

> "I won't tell anyone, Catra. Promise."
>
> "It's not fucking happening, Adora," Catra gets out in response, gritting her teeth as she fidgets, clearly just barely fighting the urge to scratch her head against the bunk-bed post or Adora's mattress.
>
> (Catra begrudgingly needs help, and Adora's all too happy to give it)

"I won't tell anyone, Catra. Promise."

"It's not *fucking happening*, Adora," Catra gets out in response, gritting her teeth as she fidgets, clearly just barely fighting the urge to scratch her head against the bunk-bed post or Adora's mattress.

It's happened a couple times in the past, but not since they were kids. It's not fleas or anything - Catra says she's never gotten them, but similar species have, so Adora thinks she must have at some point and just not told anyone - but it's still a need to be pet.

That sounds like she's minimising it, in Adora's mind, but that's pretty much what it is, on the face of it.

When they were just little kids, and Catra was more open with less of a reputation to uphold, it was never a problem. Adora could scratch behind Catra's ears and scratch her back for as long as Catra needed her to, until she was just a puddle, happy and content.

They'd even do it not caring if anyone saw, back then. Catra wasn't afraid to ask for Adora's help and Adora was all too happy to give it, even with the possibility that others might see and judge them.

It isn't like that now.

They're not necessarily 'the big kids' but they are bigger, and Catra's been working for years on being someone that you 'don't fuck with' as she puts it. Adora's not sure how old she is - how old both of them are - but somewhere in the back of her mind, she feels like they shouldn't have to hide it.

That they should be allowed to be…..to be the 'medium kids'. Not big kids but not little kids either. Kids that can be a little bit grownup but can still have fun like they used to, at least a little bit.

They can't though.

Partially because of Catra's desire to be taken seriously, and also because Adora knows that they'd get in *so much trouble* if they

ever did anything like that in front of everyone.

Right now though, she feels like it should be safe. It's late at night, just the two of them awake in their dorm, and Catra needs this, so it just seems stupid to Adora that she won't let her do anything to help.

No one will know but the two of them, and since they've already done it before, it's not like this is any big new secret.

"Why not?" Adora asks, because maybe if she figures out why Catra won't let her help, she'll be able to convince her how stupid it is.

Although Catra's smarter than Adora, so maybe she knows something that Adora doesn't.

Not that Adora would push her too hard or anything though. If Catra truly doesn't want to do something, Adora wouldn't make her do it, but she just thinks that Catra's putting up a front right now.

"Why not?" Catra scoffs, discreetly rubbing her cheek against the bunk-bed post again. Adora doesn't say anything though, because she did it in secret for a reason, and more than anything, Adora wants Catra to trust her as much as she trusts Catra.

“Because it’s fucking stupid, that’s *why not* ,” Catra continues, hissing as best she can while still keeping her voice down so as to not wake Kyle, Lonnie or Rogelio. “I don’t need you to scratch my head because of some stupid feeling. We’re not kids, Adora. I don’t need you like that anymore.”

Adora can tell that the last comment is just in there to hurt her, to make her not want to offer the help. It’s not going to deter her though, because she knows Catra well enough to know that she probably does want it, and is instead just putting up a front.

Adora finds it kind of sad, for a reason that she can’t quite explain.

“We’re not the big big kids either though,” Adora explains, and Catra narrows her eyes at that, clearly trying to think if what Adora’s saying makes sense and is a good enough excuse for her to let Adora try.

“We can still do some secret little kid stuff. Especially when no one can see us,” Adora continues, thinking that’s a pretty good argument and reasoning to actually let her help Catra.

Catra looks like she’s running through that all in her head the split second after Adora says it, considering what her options are and if she’ll actually let her do it.

It must work out though, because soon enough Catra's crawling around so that her head is closer to where Adora is sitting at the top of her bed, and she looks up at Adora with narrowed eyes, even while she rubs herself quietly against Adora's knee.

"Just be quick. And be quiet," Catra hisses, and Adora can't help her grin, happily taking Catra up on her offer now.

She runs her fingers through Catra's mane, being true to her word and not saying a thing, even when Catra starts to purr, just a little bit.

She hasn't done that in years, and even now she's trying to muffle it against the sheets, but she can't help it with how she's feeling right now, squirming and purring in Adora's lap as she gets what she's obviously been craving.

"Not a word," Catra gets out, just barely, likely wanting to swear Adora to secrecy and ensure that what's happening here never sees the light of day.

"Not a word," Adora grins, using a hand to mime, locking her lips and throwing away the key.

She's unable to tamp down that grin as Catra purrs at that, a brief happy reprieve for her.

Fifteen Years Old

Chapter Summary

> "We're almost there Catra! You can't give up now!"
>
> "We're not almost there," Catra retorts, and Adora just glares at her slightly, because even if they aren't right there, they're pretty close. Closer than they ever have been, age-wise, to becoming Force Captains. "We still have like….two or three years before you're a Force Captain."
>
> "Before we're Force Captains," Adora corrects, getting an eye-roll from Catra in response.
>
> (Adora and Catra begin Force Captain training)

"We're almost there Catra! You can't give up now!"

"We're not almost there," Catra retorts, and Adora just glares at her slightly, because even if they aren't *right there* , they're pretty close. Closer than they ever have been, age-wise, to becoming Force Captains. "We still have like….two or three years before you're a Force Captain."

"Before *we're* Force Captains," Adora corrects, getting an eye-roll from Catra in response.

"Sure, Adora," Catra sighs, and Adora really wants to say something about that, but Catra's still talking so she doesn't have

the chance. “That still doesn’t mean that you have to be training for Force Captain tests right now. It’s stupid.”

“It’s not stupid!” Adora argues, stamping her foot in argument as she twirls the staff around in her hand. “I just want to train so that I know I can pass the special tests when they give them to us. That’s all.”

“I never should have given you that stupid book,” Catra sighs, plopping down onto the training room floor like a petulant child before laying down on her back. “It’s gonna mess with your mind. I’m going to need to start calling you Force Captain wannabe instead of Adora.”

Adora narrows her eyes at that but she doesn’t say anything else, twirling the staff around in her hand. Catra found an old Force Captain initiation book last week, and it talked about all the specific unique training drills that you have to go through. Ones that Adora’s never done before, or any of the other cadets in their group, for that matter.

They’re different so that cadets aren’t supposed to be able to train specifically for the initiations, and instead they have to show ‘problem solving acumen’.

At least, that’s what the book says.

It’s from a couple years ago, so the drills might have even been changed at this point, but that doesn’t stop Adora from wanting to put her best foot forward and get these drills nailed down in case they’re still the same.

“You’re gonna be a Force Captain no matter what, dummy,” Catra groans, stretching her arms up overhead as she lays on her back. Adora can’t tear her eyes away from that motion though, watching as Catra’s shirt rides up just a little bit to show her stomach - Catra doesn’t get new clothes as quickly as the other cadets - Adora’s eyes trailing the motion.

At least they are until Catra looks like she’s about to sit back up.

Adora tears her eyes away at that, cheeks flushed red, and she purposefully does a couple moves with the staff to make it seem like she’s just working up a bit of a sweat.

“It never hurts to be prepared, Catra,” Adora retorts, stretching her legs out a little bit behind her.

She thinks for a split second that Catra’s watching her the same way that she was watching Catra, but when she looks back Catra is sprawled out again, so Adora knows that she was imagining things.

“Yeah, *it does* . Like if you mess up and hit yourself in the face with your staff again.”

“That was…….a long time ago!” Adora argues, because even if she understands the concept of age, she doesn’t know how old she is, so she just has to say something general instead. Catra takes it as Adora being flustered and not having an argument though, if the cackle that Adora hears is any indication.

“Not long enough ago that I’ve forgotten it,” Catra continues, and Adora pouts, hard enough that Catra must feel at least a little bit bad.

Adora can tell because Catra stands up in front of her, flexing her hands in a way that’s obviously meant to draw attention to her claws. It’s her way of preparing Adora for what’s about to happen next, so Adora’s able to bring the staff up to block her swipe just in time.

“I thought you said it was….stupid to train already,” Adora gets out between parries, Catra jumping over the sweep of the leg that she tries a second later. “That I was….that I was *dumb* .”

“You are dumb,” Catra agrees, Adora snorting at that before she quickly dodges another attack from Catra, only to counter with a punch of her own. “You’re dumb enough that you’ll go to Octavia or someone to help you if I don’t instead. And I wouldn’t want you to get beat up too badly.”

“I knew you cared,” Adora teases, prompting a scoff from Catra, who’s kick Adora only just barely manages to dodge.

Adora knows that there's more to it than that, that Catra's jealous streak is strong enough that she genuinely would hate Adora going to someone else to train, but she doesn't say anything. She lets Catra have that for now, because it's better than calling her out on it and Catra skulking away because she feels too vulnerable.

So for now, she just jumps over Catra's sweeping kick again, but lets out a sound of surprise as she gets punched in the stomach, falling onto her back with a thud.

It doesn't help that the staff falls on top of her and hits her in the stomach, Catra laughing at that before she helps her up.

"I guess you have to keep practicing. Wouldn't want Shadow Weaver to know that her star pupil got beat up by her lowly sidekick."

Someone called Catra that the other day, and she's kept commenting on it, even though it obviously hurts her.

Adora really doesn't like it.

"A sidekick couldn't beat up their….frontkick," Adora reasons, Catra's brow furrowing at her attempt. "Doesn't matter. I bet I can

beat you this time," Adora teases, Catra rolling her eyes and looking more than a little put upon.

Nevertheless, Catra gets in her stance, letting Adora take the first swing.

Sixteen Years Old

Chapter Summary

> "It's next year, Catra," Adora sighs as she lays back on the roof, a wide smile on her face. "We'll be Force Captain's together next year!"
>
> Catra doesn't say anything though, and Adora pops up, frowning at the way that Catra's sitting. She's still on the edge of the roof, knee against her chest, but her ears are flat against her scalp in that way that Adora knows means that she's thinking bad thoughts.
>
> That she's sad, or scared or nervous, and Adora really doesn't get why Catra would be.
>
> (Catra and Adora, their final year in the Fright Zone together)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"It's next year, Catra," Adora sighs as she lays back on the roof, a wide smile on her face. "We'll be Force Captain's together *next year!* "

Catra doesn't say anything though, and Adora pops up, frowning at the way that Catra's sitting. She's still on the edge of the roof, knee against her chest, but her ears are flat against her scalp in

that way that Adora knows means that she's thinking bad thoughts.

That she's sad, or scared or nervous, and Adora really doesn't get why Catra would be.

She knows that Shadow Weaver isn't nice to Catra, but she also knows that Shadow Weaver wants the Horde to beat the Rebellion and the Princesses, so it would be really stupid not to make Catra a Force Captain.

Adora's at the top of their cadet group, but Catra's definitely second, and could probably even be first if she tried a little bit harder and didn't skip so many tests. Anyone should be able to see that, so Adora really doesn't think that there would be any reason not to make Catra a Force Captain.

Plus, she *really* ***really*** wants it to happen, because that's all that they've ever wanted.

"What's wrong?" She asks, and Catra's ears flatten even more, if that's possible. Her tail is thumping against the roof, and she's so obviously sad, even if there's no real triggers that Adora can think of.

"Nothing's wrong," Catra says defensively, and Adora would roll her eyes and scoff at that if she didn't think it would make Catra run away.

So she makes her way to the edge of the roof alongside her, sitting with her legs dangling over the edge. “Something’s wrong,” she reasons, and Catra sighs again, in that way that Adora knows means that she’s trying to figure out if she should talk to Adora or not.

“Do you really think they’ll make me Force Captain?” Catra asks, and it sounds *so sad* .

Adora really wishes that Catra could see herself in the way that Adora sees Catra.

Well, maybe not the exact same way, because Adora feels a lot of things about Catra that she’d be really embarrassed by if Catra found out.

“Of course they will,” Adora argues, putting as much conviction as she can into her voice.

Catra always says that she’s a terrible actor - she did almost fail all their espionage classes, while Catra passed them with flying colours - so she hopes that Catra will see how earnest she’s being.

She apparently does, because a soft smile comes to Catra’s face - as soft as Catra can be, probably - and she takes her mask off, setting it aside.

Adora's always taken aback when Catra does that, because she looks *so beautiful* . Even more than she usually does.

She rests her head on Adora's shoulder too, which is weird, but definitely not a bad weird.

It's a good weird. A *very* good weird.

"What do you think it's like out there?"

Catra's question throws Adora for a loop, and it's only a second later that she realizes that she's talking about the Whispering Woods. Or what's beyond, the Whispering Woods, really.

"Well, there's Princesses…..so it's probably pretty bad, and all the citizens could really use the Horde to help them escape and….." Adora starts, but Catra cuts her off, shaking her head against her shoulder.

"Not what the Horde thinks is out there. What ***you*** think is out there," Catra clarifies, and Adora takes a breath.

Even if she's getting older, the Horde still shapes a big part of her thinking, and it's hard to think for herself sometimes.

"I….I think it's cleaner than the Fright Zone," Adora reasons, because even if the Princesses are bad and they treat their people badly, the air looks nicer beyond the Whispering Woods. "Like there isn't as much smoke. There's probably a ton more grass too. You could really dig your claws into it," Adora giggles, thinking of all the times that they've been on the edge of the Whispering Woods and that Catra has loved doing that.

"There's probably water in there too. I know you don't like it, but I bet I could….what's it called when you take a shower laying down?" Adora questions, because they've seen it in books, but they've never actually done it themselves.

Catra would hate it, obviously, but Adora thinks that she'd like that.

"A bath," Catra says, voice soft, and Adora hums as she nods.

She leans more into Catra the whole time, but neither of them say anything.

"Right….a bath. I bet there's places with grass and trees that you can just have baths in too. And there might be people like you too!"

"You think?" Catra questions, and her voice cracks just enough for Adora to know that there's tears, but she doesn't say anything.

“You came from somewhere, right?” Adora reasons, Catra’s purrs starting now. “There might be. Maybe even in the Whispering Woods, since you came here yourself, not with anyone.”

“And we’ll do it together?” Catra asks again, and Adora smiles, because that’s one thing that, above all else, she knows.

They’ll be together, for as long as they’re able to be.

Ever since Adora found Catra in that box, all those years ago, she’s known that they’d be together forever.

Maybe….maybe as something more than they are right now. Adora doesn’t let herself think too hard on that, but she knows that she wouldn’t mind if they were more than what they are.

Adora doesn’t know what you’d call that, but she knows that she’d like it if Catra slept in her bed the same way that she did, side by side.

She knows that she wishes that Catra would touch her more than she does, and on purpose too.

She knows that she wants to be with Catra, forever and always, and that there’s nothing that could tear them apart.

“Yeah Catra…..together,” she smiles, leaning her head against Catra’s as they sit there, overlooking the Whispering Woods.

Chapter End Notes

So....that's that! It took way longer to finish than I wanted it to, because of school and all that, but it's done now and I really enjoyed it!

I hope you guys liked reading it as much as I liked writing it :)

End Notes

Hi all!

So, I don't have a clear plan for when each chapter will be posted, but I intend to do one for every year that they're in the Fright Zone together, so it'll probably be.....17 or 18 chapters, by the time it's done? They'll all be around the same length as this first one though, so I hope it doesn't take too long.

Hope you all liked it :)

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!